

Regular Meeting
October 16, 2017
School Committee Meeting
Council Chambers

The regular meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Mayor Burke in the City Hall Council Chambers at 7:11 p.m. Those present were Ms. Cugno, Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Skerry, Mayor Burke and Superintendent Belson. Ms. Van der Kloot was absent. Medford High School student representative Sebastian Tringale was present.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto that the minutes of October 2, 2017 be approved:

As amended by Ms. DiBenedetto:

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto that the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved:

Voted: That the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved.

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 1 Van der Kloot

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Skerry that the Payrolls be approved:

Voted: That the Payrolls be approved

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 1 Van der Kloot

Mr. Skerry will act as Secretary in the absence of Ms. Van der Kloot.

Community Participation

Joseph Viglione, 59 Garfield Avenue, Medford was given permission to speak. Mr. Viglione spoke about the lack of posting of the advisory meeting according to the open meeting law requirements. When Mr. Viglione began speaking about another topic the Mayor asked him to speak on the subject or end his presentation.

Report on Nellie Mae Education Foundation Grant

Superintendent Belson reported that the Nellie Mae Education Foundation has awarded a \$15,000 grant to Medford High School to support the work proposed by Guidance Counselor Tim Klein, a 2017 winner of the Lawrence O'Toole Leadership Award.

Last year Mr. Klein launched the MPOWER program to increase the motivation of senior students to pursue meaningful and career pathways. The program along with other steps taken by the high school administration and faculty has yielded significant positive outcomes. The Nellie Mae Grant will enable the guidance department to further develop and expand the program. Superintendent introduced Amelia Jensen and Tim Klein. Ms. Jensen said that the O'Toole Award honors New England public high school teachers who have served as advocates for and champions of student-centered learning and who have advocated for student-centered approaches to learning not only in their classroom but at scale. The award is sponsored by Nellie Mae Foundation. Tim won this award as a result of his innovative pilot program, MPOWER.

Discussion:

Ms. Cugno stressed the importance of working with the students to learn what interest them. The best time is during the day if there is flexibility in schedules. If this is not possible after school and/or Saturdays may be possible. Student Sebastian Tringale commented that Mr. Klein is like the extra pair of hands in the guidance department – he helps everyone. Ms. Kreatz asked how to contact Mr. Klein. He replied that he has an open door policy. Ms. DiBenedetto commented that this is an example of how we handle the Whole Child in Medford by trying to meet their needs. She stated that work experience is so important with learning professional skills. She is very proud of our approach to the Whole Child.

On the motion of Ms. Cugno seconded by Ms. Mustone to accept report and place on file.

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Report on Online 4 Good Academy

Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell presented the report. Ms. Caldwell reported that on Thursday, Sept. 28th four eighth grade students from the Andrews Middle School and teacher Chris Tremonte attended a day long program on “Social Media for Social Good.” John Rendon, President and Chief Executive Officer of the Rendon Group discussed strategic communications in the 21st century and Macon Phillips skyped from Spain to talk about using social media for the social good. The highlight for many was Andrew Frates, brother of Pete Frates. He described how the Ice Bucket Challenge came about and how through social media people from all over the world participated. Students Andre Perez and Sarah Bien-Aime told the school committee what they learned at the conference.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto said that she is very impressed and asked the students what different thing they have done. The students responded that they are careful about what they put on the internet, look at things more carefully now and they think before speaking.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Mustone that the students share what they learned with the McGlynn 6th grade:

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Skerry that both schools attend the forum next year:

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Ms. Cugno commented that not only students but adults could use a refresher course as well. Be careful what you write. Ms. Cugno asked if you have learned a different way to think about things before you write. Andre answered that it never goes away what you put in writing so think first.

On the motion of Ms. Cugno seconded by Mr. Skerry the report was accepted and placed on file:

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Report on Global Scholars Program

Superintendent Belson introduced Director of Curriculum Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli to present the report. Dr. Ricciardelli stated that the Global Scholars Program is now in its fourth year at our two middle schools. The program is integrated into our 7th grade world geography curriculum. The Global Scholars Program is an initiative of the Global Cities Program which is funded by the New York City based non-profit Bloomberg Philanthropies Foundation. Medford has been a pioneer school system in Massachusetts with this program. Most of the involved cities are large metropolises around the globe. As such we have had the opportunity to help shape the curriculum and methodologies involved with its implementation and development. This year the program focus will be on the global food system. Students will learn about nutrition and food access and their influences on public health. This will lead to community based health projects in their respective cities. The Global Scholars Program this year will also hold an international symposium focused on “Evaluating Student Outcomes for Global Digital Education” in Paris, France. This symposium will bring together educators from around the globe. Medford will be represented at this conference by Middle School Teacher Frank Zizzo and your Superintendent of Schools. Mr. Zizzo was selected by the Global Cities Team for his innovative applications of technology that enhanced communication between students in participating cities.

Superintendent Belson continued. He said that as Superintendent I have been able to advise the program on organizational and curriculum matters. We have worked with the program to link participation to significant educational outcomes. Bloomberg Philanthropies will cover the costs associated with the participation of both Mr. Zizzo and the Superintendent in the symposium. Under State ethics rules Mr. Zizzo’s funded expenses have been approved by me as Superintendent as his appointing authority. However, my funded expenses must be authorized by the Medford School Committee.

As such I have included the appropriate Disclosure form required by the Commission. Bloomberg Philanthropies will cover my round trip airfare, transportation, two nights in a hotel and food. I estimate that the total value will be between \$1500 and \$2000. My wife, Maxine Wish, will accompany me on this trip and I will personally pay for all her expenses including airfare, food and hotel surcharges for double occupancy. I plan to stay in Paris for two extra days at my own expense. Therefore, I respectfully request approval from the Medford School Committee for Bloomberg Philanthropies to pay my symposium related expenses.

Discussion:

Ms. Cugno commented that is very impressive to hear Medford is participating in this incredible opportunity. She listed the other cities being represented and said it is very important to approve this. Ms. DiBenedetto asked if we are the only Massachusetts school district being represented. Superintendent Belson answered that Everett and Boston are also attending. Ms. Mustone asked if there is a point person at the McGlynn. Superintendent Belson explained that Frank Zizzo was selected for his introduction of Skype and being very involved in the technology from inception.

On the motion of Ms. Cugno seconded by Ms. Kreatz to approve Bloomberg Philanthropies to pay the Superintendent's symposium related expenses.

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 Van der Kloot

Recommendation to Accept Buddy Bench Donation

Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell reported that Mark Tonello is donating a buddy bench to the Brooks Elementary School library in memory of his uncle Victor Lepore. Mr. Lepore taught English and reading for thirty years in Medford. In his very early teaching years he taught at the Dame School and then at the Hobbs Jr. High School. School Committee member Robert E. Skerry Jr. constructed the bench for the Tonello/DiPaula family. The dedication will take place on Friday, Oct. 20th at the Brooks School at 4: 00 p.m.

Discussion:

Ms. Cugno requested that a letter be sent to Mark Tonello.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Skerry to accept the buddy bench:

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 Van der Kloot

Report on Kiwanis Book Donation

Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell said that the Medford Public Schools would once again like to thank the Kiwanis Club of Medford for their generous donation of books to our first and third grade students. Kiwanis has always gone above and beyond for the children of Medford. In June, members of Kiwanis visited each of our schools and gave each child a bag filled with new books for summer reading. The children could

not wait to open their bags and begin reading their books. The children often read and trade books on the very same day. Ms. Caldwell read three thank you letters from the students. Members from Kiwanis that were present at the meeting included Kelly Catallo, Andrea Bates McGrath, Rick Caraviello and Chuck Veneziano.

Discussion:

Ms. Cugno requested that a letter be sent to the Kiwanis Club.

On the motion of Ms. Mustone seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Report on Professional Development Day November 7, 2017

Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell presented the report. She stated that on Tuesday, November 7th the Medford Public Schools staff will participate in our first professional development day for this school year. Elementary staff will participate in grade level workshops on *Response to Intervention*. The middle schools will participate in *Study Island* as a universal screening/behavioral intervention tool. The high school/vocational and Curtis-Tufts staff will participate in workshops regarding specific building based data collection in focus group discussions and identify topics from their ongoing partnerships with Harvard and Boston College. Paraprofessionals will collaborate with each other on online curriculum in three research based modules. Fine arts will focus on teaching pathways through music curriculum as well as concepts in art education. Nurses, physical education and health education staff will participate in safety care recertification training. A full report will be provided after November 7th.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto asked if additional staff will be invited to the RTI training. Ms. Caldwell answered that most elementary staff will be involved with RTI, they all learn together so they can all help students.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto to receive an update on the next steps regarding RTI and an update February 1st on how it is going so we can plan at budget time.

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Ms. DiBenedetto also said that she had requested a report on the breakdown of male/female athletic concussions versus male/female non-athletic concussions.

Report on Elementary Science Program SY 2017-2018

Director of Science Rocco Cieri presented the report. Mr. Cieri said that efforts to realign the Science and Technology/Engineering curriculum began by reviewing the

curriculum frameworks. At the middle and high school level, teachers were provided with copies of the New Curriculum Framework for Science and Technology/Engineering. Every teacher was requested to read and to review the grade-level or subject-level standards specific to their assignment. Teachers were invited to participate in a Science Curriculum Task Force, in which the MCAS-specific content would be unpacked. The Science Curriculum Task Force documents are currently being reviewed by grade-level teachers and subject-specific teachers. Once comments and adjustments are made to them, the document will be available in draft form. For elementary school teachers, two “Introduction to the Science and Technology Curriculum Frameworks” workshops were offered during Wednesday early release days. Faculty from all elementary school buildings could attend the sessions and receive 2 PDPs for participating in the session.

The Director’s Recommendation:

I agree with the most selected programs for piloting. At this time, McGraw-Hill *Inspire Science* is aligned with the MA Curriculum Frameworks Science and Technology/Engineering content at each grade level. Pearson’s *Elevate Science* is content aligned with MA Curriculum Frameworks based upon the National Program’s Table of Contents, shared with me via e-mail. The Science program review committee did not have access Pearson’s *Elevate Science* Table of Contents at the time they submitted their recommendations for a pilot. Pearson is, however, interested in preparing a bid, if the school committee intends to consider adopting a program in the upcoming school year. Delta Education’s *FOSS* program has a long history and is used in the communities of Melrose, Andover, Peabody, and Arlington. It is a well-known program in the area. There are currently 48 teachers piloting McGraw-Hill *Inspire Science*. We have provided faculty professional development that focuses on implementation using the program. In addition, the Science program supports students by scaffolding learning (Be A Scientist Journal), increase non-fiction reading texts (Science Handbook for grades 3-5; Leveled Readers K-5), writing and communication, and allow for scientific problem solving (Hands-on group kits). McGraw-Hill’s *Inspire Science* program was adopted this year by Stoneham Public Schools at the K-5 grade level. In addition, we have reached an agreement with Delta Education to pilot one unit of the *FOSS NextGen* program for grades K-4 with 8 teachers at the Brooks Elementary School with professional development. There are enough materials to use for up to 2 classrooms per grade, where appropriate. The pilot of *FOSS NextGen* is important, since our faculty will need to evaluate the program to determine how it meets the MA STE Framework in elementary school classrooms as well as its fit for our student population. Writing is threaded throughout the program, despite that this program is known as a very hands-on program. Either program will require the purchase of consumable materials, which will need to be replenished over time. During this school year, I am working with the elementary school faculty and administration to identify a plan for replenishing materials and replacing damaged materials moving into the future. The additional \$30,000 funding provided in the budget this school year is ear-marked to purchase classroom materials and tools that will support Science instruction, no matter the program selected moving forward. In addition, teachers not piloting new programs, who request materials, will be supported with the funding. Moving into the future, the district will need a plan to budget for and to support the hands-on, consumables needed for Science instruction. This pilot schedule will allow the district to make a program adoption decision for the 2018-2019 school year.

Discussion:

Mr. Skerry asked Mr. Cieri to provide a sample to the school committee. Ms. Cugno asked if teachers have been trained using the materials. Mr. Cieri responded that they have been trained. Ms. Mustone asked if Stoneham has any regrets. Mr. Cieri said none that he is aware of.

On the motion of Ms. Mustone seconded by Ms. Cugno to accept report and place on file:
Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Report on Vocational Technical Advisory Committee Schedule

Superintendent Belson reported that Chapter 74 programs must have active advisory committees that met a minimum of two times per year. The committee members serve as resources to the school administration and the various shop instructors. They are composed of a wide variety of expertise and experience. Categories include business owners, managers, technicians, university instructors, engineers, teachers, students and parents. They are also helpful in finding co-op learning opportunities for our students. Please find attached a Public Notice of the two required meeting dates for this school year which will be held at the Vocational Technical High School. A general agenda is also provided to help each committee conduct its session. Although the formal meetings are only two times per year, individual members are available to advise the administration and instructors throughout the year. While all members may not make each meeting, a listing is provided to you of the current members. There are 16 working groups covering the 20 program areas. Four areas are combined to optimize collaboration between related programs.

Discussion:

Ms. Kreatz asked for a breakdown of the numbers on each cooperative shop.

On the motion of Ms. Cugno seconded by Ms. Mustone the report was accepted and placed on file.

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Old Business:

Superintendent Belson asked the committee members if anyone was planning on attending the MASS/MASC conference so a delegate/alternate could be named. Ms. Cugno stressed the importance of attending because of the networking, beneficial information learned and various workshops that are held.

New Business:

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Al Cannava. Mr. Cannava was the father of former School Committee member Richard Cannava and former art teacher Christine Cannava.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Rosemary Sweeney. Ms. Sweeney was a paraprofessional for the Medford Public Schools.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Officer Louis Remigio. Officer Remigio was the brother of Brooks School Librarian Natalie Pereira and uncle of Ms. Pereira's two children that attend Medford High School.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Ann Volpe. Ms. Volpe was a former elementary teacher at the Kennedy school and the wife of the late Larry Volpe former Director of the Vocational School.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Eleanor Demos. Mrs. Demos was the wife of James Demos former Director of Pupil Services and the mother in law of Shannon

A moment of silence was held.

Requested Report on November 13, 2017

A report was requested on the number of students taking the bus from North Medford to school and home in the afternoon. Also the number of id's given out was requested.

Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson gave a brief explanation about the MCAS results and accountability rating.

On the motion of Cugno seconded by Ms. Mustone to go into Executive Session at 9:05 p.m.

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 Van der Kloot

Respectfully submitted:

Robert Skerry
Secretary Pro Tempore

